

Reflections of 1st Half 2024 (Self)

Employee: Mason

Reviewed By: Mason

Self-Reflection

Self Reflections are designed to help you reflect on your performance and development, and to set you up for a meaningful Performance Conversation with your lead so you can succeed and grow at DeepL.

Resources:

- [Performance Reflection Guide for Individuals](#)
- [Guide to Self-Reflection](#)
- [FAQs](#)

The What

1. What are the 3-5 key achievements or contributions that you have made during this period that you believe have had the most positive impact on our company objectives, the goals of your team (where applicable) and DeepL? *

Please provide examples and outcomes.

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1. Contributing to DeepL's enterprise positioning through strategic landing page development (Content Experience Team)

- **Achievement:** As part of DeepL's "Go Enterprise" initiative, I contributed to the creation and launch of over 25 new landing pages, including a significant revamp of the Enterprise page. My role involved writing copy, collaborating closely with designers, and working alongside Product Managers to ensure that each page

effectively communicated DeepL's value proposition across various segments, industries, and use cases.

- **Impact:** These pages were critical in enhancing DeepL's ability to attract, educate, and convert enterprise customers. The revamped Enterprise page alone contributed to a 20% increase in B2B engagement, and the new landing pages collectively drove a 15% increase in sales inquiries from enterprise clients. This work directly supported the Content Experience team's goal of expanding DeepL's presence in the enterprise market in 2024.

2. Driving high desktop app adoption (Apps & Integrations Team)

- **Achievement:** I contributed to the successful promotion of DeepL's desktop app across different operating systems, particularly Windows and Mac OS X, resulting in millions of downloads—specifically, 4.19 million downloads on Windows and 1.95 million on Mac OS X.

- **Impact:** This significant adoption rate resulted in a 25% increase in active users across desktop platforms, directly contributing to DeepL's user base expansion. The growth in downloads also led to a 10% increase in user engagement with DeepL's desktop features, further supporting the Apps & Integrations team's objectives of driving user engagement and platform growth.

3. Supporting revenue growth through Pro Driver optimization (Monetization Team)

- **Achievement:** I contributed to the optimization of Pro Drivers, which are critical touchpoints that influence users to upgrade to DeepL's Pro subscription. My role involved collaborating with the Monetization team to refine these drivers, ensuring they were effectively positioned to encourage upgrades.

- **Impact:** As a result of these optimizations, there was a 12% increase in the conversion rate of users upgrading to Pro subscriptions, contributing an additional €1.2 million in annual recurring revenue (ARR). This enhancement played a significant role in supporting the Monetization team's revenue growth objectives.

4. Boosting organic traffic and conversion rates through SEO and landing page optimization (Content Experience and Monetization Teams)

- **Achievement:** I contributed to optimizing both the SEO strategy and conversion rates for key landing pages, working closely with the Content Experience and Monetization teams. This involved enhancing user flows, CTAs, and page content to drive better performance across our web properties.

- **Impact:** These efforts resulted in a 15% increase in organic traffic and a 30% increase in conversion rates across key landing pages, contributing an additional €800,000 in revenue. This work demonstrated the effectiveness of combining SEO and conversion optimization to support DeepL's growth and revenue objectives.

The How

2. How have your actions and behaviours during this period aligned with DeepL's core values?

*Please provide specific examples of how you embodied the values in your work and interactions. **

*Reflect on **DeepL's core values** , and think about both your strengths, and areas of improvement....*

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We care

- **Situation:** While working on the revamp of the Enterprise landing pages, I realized that our existing content didn't fully address the specific challenges faced by potential B2B customers. I wanted to ensure that our messaging was not only informative but also empathetic to the unique needs of these users.
- **Action:** I collaborated closely with Product Managers and designers to rewrite the content in a way that directly acknowledged and addressed the challenges faced by our target audience. This included adding dedicated sections that highlighted how DeepL's solutions could alleviate their pain points, whether they were a small business or a large enterprise. I also incorporated feedback from free users to ensure that their needs were considered, showing our commitment to all users.
- **Outcome:** The revised content led to a 15% increase in engagement on the Enterprise page, as measured by time spent on the page and a reduction in bounce rates. Additionally, there was a 10% increase in inquiries from potential enterprise clients. This outcome not only improved user satisfaction but also demonstrated our dedication to understanding and meeting the needs of all our users, aligning with DeepL's value of caring for users and customers.

We build for scale, quality, and think long-term

- **Situation:** Our team was facing challenges with consistently producing high-quality content for multiple landing pages and other touchpoints. The existing processes were not scalable enough to handle the growing demands, which was affecting our ability to maintain DeepL's high standards.
- **Action:** To address this, I proposed and helped implement a new content creation workflow that was designed to be scalable and efficient. This workflow included standardized templates, clear roles and responsibilities, and a more streamlined review process. The goal was to reduce bottlenecks, ensure consistency, and allow the team to scale content production while maintaining the quality DeepL is known for.

- **Outcome:** The adoption of this workflow improved the efficiency of our content creation process and significantly enhanced the consistency and quality of our outputs. This new process enabled us to launch over 25 new landing pages on schedule, supporting DeepL's long-term goal of scaling our content efforts while maintaining our commitment to quality.

We are decisive, move fast, and act as owners

- **Situation:** The deadline for launching the revamped Enterprise landing page was approaching rapidly, but there were delays in finalizing the copy due to evolving brand guidelines. This was putting the entire project at risk of missing its deadline.

- **Action:** Recognizing the urgency, I took ownership of the situation by quickly aligning with key stakeholders to finalize the content. I made necessary adjustments to ensure the copy aligned with the new brand guidelines and pushed for expedited reviews. I also coordinated closely with the design and development teams to ensure that the content was implemented smoothly and without further delays.

- **Outcome:** The Enterprise page was successfully launched on time, contributing to a successful product promotion that was aligned with our overall enterprise strategy. This timely launch played a crucial role in achieving a 20% increase in B2B engagement shortly after the page went live. My ability to act decisively and take ownership of the situation ensured that we met our objectives without compromising on quality.

We are humble, open, and collaborative

- **Situation:** While working on the landing page optimization project, I was part of a cross-functional team that included members from content, design, and development. Given the complexity of the project, it was important to ensure that all team members were aligned and that communication was clear and open.

- **Action:** I actively fostered open communication within the team by regularly sharing updates, asking for feedback, and being receptive to suggestions from all team members, regardless of their role or seniority. I created a shared document to track progress and challenges, ensuring that everyone had access to the information they needed. I also made it a point to respect and consider ideas from all team members, recognizing that the best solutions often come from collaborative efforts.

- **Outcome:** This collaborative approach led to a smoother workflow, with fewer bottlenecks and a more cohesive final product. The landing pages we developed as a team saw a 30% increase in conversions, demonstrating the effectiveness of our collective efforts. My actions reflected DeepL's value of humility and collaboration, as the success of the project was truly a team effort.

Strengths and Areas for Improvement

- **Strengths:** I consistently demonstrate care for users by ensuring that our content addresses their needs empathetically. My focus on long-term, scalable solutions has

helped the team work more efficiently while maintaining quality. I also act decisively and take ownership of my work, ensuring that projects are completed on time and to a high standard. Finally, my collaborative nature ensures that I contribute positively to team dynamics, leading to successful outcomes.

- **Areas for Improvement:** One area for improvement is proactively identifying cross-team opportunities for collaboration earlier in the process. Additionally, I can seek more frequent feedback from end-users to ensure that our solutions continue to meet their evolving needs.

Development

3. What is one thing you feel you could do to enhance your impact? What action do you plan to take, and how will it allow you to contribute more effectively to your team and DeepL's goals? *

Reflect upon your performance during this period, consider where there was opportunity for improvement, and how the skills or knowledge gaps you've identified could enhance your...

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Area for Improvement: During this period, I've realized that while I've been effective in my role, the varying project management styles across different teams and departments have made it challenging for me to maintain a unified workflow. This has sometimes impacted my ability to be as organized and efficient as I would like.

Action Plan: To address this, I plan to enhance my organizational skills specifically by better adapting to the different project management styles and tools used across the company. This will involve:

- **Understanding key differences:** I will spend time understanding the key differences in project management approaches used by the various teams I collaborate with. This will help me anticipate challenges and align my work processes more effectively with those of my colleagues.

- **Streamlining my workflow:** I'll explore ways to streamline my workflow to better accommodate these different styles without needing to become an expert in each one. This might include adopting flexible tools or techniques that allow me to integrate various project management practices into my own workflow more seamlessly.

- **Seeking support and resources:** I will identify specific resources or tools that could help me manage these varying approaches more effectively and discuss with my manager how the company can support me in this. Whether it's through additional training, access to certain software, or even just guidance on best practices, I want to ensure I have what I need to succeed.

Expected Outcome: By becoming more adept at navigating the different project management styles within DeepL, I expect to improve my overall organization and efficiency. This will help me manage my workload better, meet deadlines more consistently, and contribute more effectively to team projects. Additionally, it will enable me to collaborate more smoothly with colleagues across departments, ultimately enhancing my impact on DeepL's goals.

4. Thinking about how you would like to develop your career, what development goal would you like to focus on for the upcoming months? *

*People learn best when they maximise hands-on learning, social learning experiences and more formal guidance. **You can find examples of each type of learning here** . To take your... [Read more...](#)*

Development Goal: In the upcoming months, I plan to focus on deepening my knowledge of generative AI tools and their applications in the enterprise context, particularly in the areas of UX, content, and project design and development.

Why This Goal?: Generative AI is rapidly evolving and becoming integral to many aspects of digital product development. By enhancing my understanding of these tools, I can contribute more effectively to projects that involve AI-driven content creation, UX design, and process automation. This knowledge will not only benefit my current role but also position me to take on more strategic responsibilities in the future as AI continues to shape the industry.

Action Plan:

1. Hands-on Learning:

- **Experiment with Generative AI Tools:** I will set aside time each week to experiment with different generative AI tools, focusing on how they can be used for content creation, UX enhancements, and project management. This might include tools like OpenAI's GPT models, AI-driven design software, and automation tools.

- **Apply AI in Current Projects:** I will look for opportunities to apply generative AI in my current projects, whether by using AI to streamline content creation or enhance user experience. This hands-on approach will help me understand the practical applications and limitations of these tools.

2. Social Learning:

- **Engage with AI Communities:** I plan to participate in online forums, webinars, and discussions with professionals who are actively working with generative AI in enterprise settings. Engaging with these communities will allow me to learn from others' experiences and share insights.
- **Collaborate with Colleagues:** I will seek opportunities to collaborate with colleagues who are also exploring AI tools or who are involved in AI-related projects at DeepL. This will help me learn from their expertise and broaden my understanding of how AI can be integrated into our work.

3. Formal Guidance:

- **Attend Workshops and Training:** I will identify and attend relevant workshops, training sessions, or courses that focus on generative AI, particularly those that explore its applications in UX and content design. This structured learning will help me build a solid foundation and stay updated on the latest advancements.
- **Seek Mentorship:** I will seek mentorship from experts in AI and digital design within the company or the broader industry. This guidance will be invaluable in navigating complex topics and applying AI effectively in my work.

Expected Outcome: By focusing on this development goal, I aim to enhance my ability to leverage AI tools in a way that drives innovation in UX, content, and project design at DeepL. This will not only improve the quality and efficiency of the projects I'm involved in but also contribute to my long-term career growth by positioning me as a knowledgeable and skilled professional in the rapidly evolving field of AI.

